MERIAN LESSTER

SENIOR FRONTEND DEVELOPER | PRODUCT ENGINEERING | PERFORMANCE & ARCHITECTURE

Amsterdam, Netherlands | merianlesster27.ml@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/merian-lesster | github.com/MerianLesster | merianlesster.github.io

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Frontend Developer with 7+ years of experience building user-facing web applications and scalable frontend systems with TypeScript, JavaScript, Vue.js, React and Angular. Strong in frontend architecture, performance optimisation, reusable component systems, SPA/SSR/SSG rendering, authentication security, and production observability. Combines a keen eye for UI/UX and Figma with pragmatic engineering, automated testing, and AI-assisted workflows that accelerate delivery without sacrificing quality or maintainability.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Frontend**: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Vue.js, React, Angular, React Native, HTML, CSS/SCSS, responsive UI
- **Architecture & Rendering:** Feature-based architecture, reusable component libraries, composables, design systems, SPA, SSR, SSG, hydration, code splitting, lazy loading, asset prioritisation, React Hooks
- **Quality & Observability:** Unit and end-to-end testing, Playwright, Storybook, Jest, Sentry, performance profiling
- **Product & Delivery**: Figma, UI/UX, Agile, REST APIs, CI/CD, Git, Node.js, TanStack, Claude Design

WORK EXPERIENCE

7+ years

Senior Frontend Developer | Experiencegift
March 2026 – Present | Amsterdam, Netherlands
Product: Experiencegift · Away.ai

- Led a major refactor of a Vue/TypeScript codebase for a new brand within a multi-brand monorepo, introducing feature-based architecture, reusable components, composables and utilities to improve scalability and maintainability.
- Develop and optimise interactive AI-powered chat experiences and complex booking workflows for Away.ai, enhancing usability, responsiveness, and the overall travel planning experience.
- Built a reusable component library with Storybook and established a testing strategy spanning unit and end-to-end tests to validate UI behaviour and reduce regression risk.
- Improved frontend performance through code splitting, lazy loading, asset prioritisation, and SSG hydration optimisations, increasing the Google Lighthouse performance score from 76 to 95 (+25%)
- Implemented Sentry monitoring with session replay and improved authentication and error-handling workflows to make frontend issues easier to diagnose and resolve.
- Replaced manual Figma-to-code workflows with AI-assisted page-to-code generation, evolving from Builder.io's component-by-component exports to a custom Claude Design skill for full-page exports. Integrated Claude Code to generate reusable components, Storybook stories, and unit tests while enforcing frontend architecture guidelines, reducing implementation time from over a day to under 30 minutes.
- Resolved a cross-tab authentication security issue by removing an insecure localStorage fallback and using the BroadcastChannel API.
- Reduced deployment pipeline time from approximately 7 to 4 minutes (43%) through caching improvements.

Frontend Developer | Stekz (Media2B B.V.)
Nov 2021 – Mar 2026 | Groningen, Netherlands

- Served as the go-to person for frontend engineering and UI/UX, helping the team solve complex interface challenges and make practical design and implementation decisions.
- Collaborated with developers and project managers in Figma-based design sprints to establish a shared component library and improve consistency between design and implementation.
- Built a framework-agnostic component library using Web Components and Lit, enabling reusable UI across multiple projects.
- Introduced a modern Vue.js architecture using PrimeVue, Pinia, VeeValidate, Vue I18n, and type-safe file-based routing to improve maintainability and development workflows.
- Implemented AG Grid for a data-intensive interface with row-level validation, supporting complex data operations and improving the user experience.
- Optimised a deeply nested tree-view interface through breadcrumb-based progressive disclosure, significantly reducing rendering overhead and making complex hierarchies easier to navigate.

Frontend Developer | iTelasoft (Pvt) Ltd.
Jul 2019 – Nov 2021 | Colombo, Sri Lanka

- Led a UX overhaul of the onboarding flow, leveraging user research and A/B testing to identify friction points and improve the overall user journey.
- Improved frontend performance for large datasets using dynamic component loading and virtualised lists.
- Modernised legacy JavaScript using ES6+ and asynchronous programming patterns, improving readability and reducing technical debt.
- Collaborated with backend developers to integrate REST APIs and deliver new product features.
- Trained and mentored five new team members, helping them become familiar with the team's programming languages and development practices.

REACT & MODERN FRONTEND DEVELOPMENT

Built personal projects with React, exploring modern React patterns, hooks, component composition, state management, TypeScript integration, and performance optimisation using React Compiler and manual memoization where appropriate. Practised data fetching and server-state management with TanStack Query and gained exposure to React Native. Confident in quickly navigating large React codebases, understanding existing architecture, and contributing to complex production applications. Professional production experience is primarily in Vue.js.

EDUCATION

- B.Sc (Hons) in Computer Science | University of Westminster | First Class — May 2021
- Higher Diploma in Computing & Software Engineering | Cardiff Metropolitan University | First Class — Nov 2017
- Diploma in Computing & Software Engineering | Cardiff Metropolitan University | First Class — Mar 2017

AWARDS & CERTIFICATIONS

- Toastmasters Speechcraft — July 2022
- Research Paper Publication iCIIT | MamaMoods: Antenatal Mental Health Awareness Serious Game — Feb 2022
- NBQSA National ICT Awards | Merit Award | MamaMoods — Jan 2021
- Cutting Edge Final Year Best Project | Bronze Award | MamaMoods — July 2021
- 2nd Runner-Up at Yarl Geek Challenge Season 7 — Nov 2018